

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - The Rainforest Sound Map

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY05 - use comprehension strategies to build literal and inferred meaning, expand ideas and evaluate texts.

Learning Intention

Read an informational text and use details to explain how sounds help people understand a place.

Reading Strategy

Listen with your imagination. Visualise what each sound tells you about the rainforest.

Vocabulary Helper

canopy - the upper layer of trees in a forest

echo - a sound that bounces back

observe - to watch or notice carefully

The Rainforest Sound Map

A rainforest can be mapped with more than lines and labels. Scientists and students sometimes create sound maps to show what they can hear in different parts of the forest. A sound map might include bird calls, dripping water, rustling leaves and the distant rumble of thunder.

In the morning, the canopy is often busy. Birds call to one another, insects buzz and leaves move as small animals travel along branches. Near a creek, water splashes over stones. The sound may become louder after rain because more water flows through the forest.

Sound maps help people observe carefully. Instead of rushing through a place, they stop, listen and record details. A sudden silence can also be important. It may mean an animal has hidden, or that people have become too noisy.

When students compare sound maps from different days, they can notice patterns. A wet day may have more dripping sounds, while a hot afternoon may seem quieter. By listening closely, students learn that a rainforest is not just a place to see. It is a place full of clues to hear.

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Page 2 - Questions and written response

Warm Up - Quick check

Circle the type of text: Story / Information text / Poem

Build Your Skills

1. What is a sound map used to show?

2. List two sounds that might be included on a rainforest sound map.

3. Why might creek sounds become louder after rain?

4. How can a sudden silence be important?

5. What pattern might students notice on a wet day?

6. What is the main idea of the final paragraph?

Reading Challenge

Write one sentence explaining why listening carefully can help students understand a rainforest.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can read carefully.

☐ I can use evidence.

☐ I can answer in full sentences.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____



High Five!

You used your reading ears and your thinking brain. Wonderful evidence work!

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - The Rainforest Sound Map Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer: Information text.

Detailed answers

1. A sound map is used to show what people can hear in different parts of the forest.
2. Possible answers include bird calls, dripping water, rustling leaves, insects buzzing or thunder.
3. Creek sounds can become louder because more water flows through the forest after rain.
4. It may mean an animal has hidden or that people have become too noisy.
5. They may notice more dripping sounds on a wet day.
6. The main idea is that rainforests can be understood by listening, not only by looking.

Challenge answer: Accept answers explaining that sounds give clues about animals, weather, water and changes in the rainforest.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, make a five-minute backyard sound map. Let your child draw funny symbols for sounds like birds, cars, wind or a barking dog.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Ask students to identify whether each answer is literal, inferred or main idea. This makes comprehension strategies visible.

Extension Idea

Create a sound map for your classroom or playground and write a short paragraph about the loudest and quietest areas.